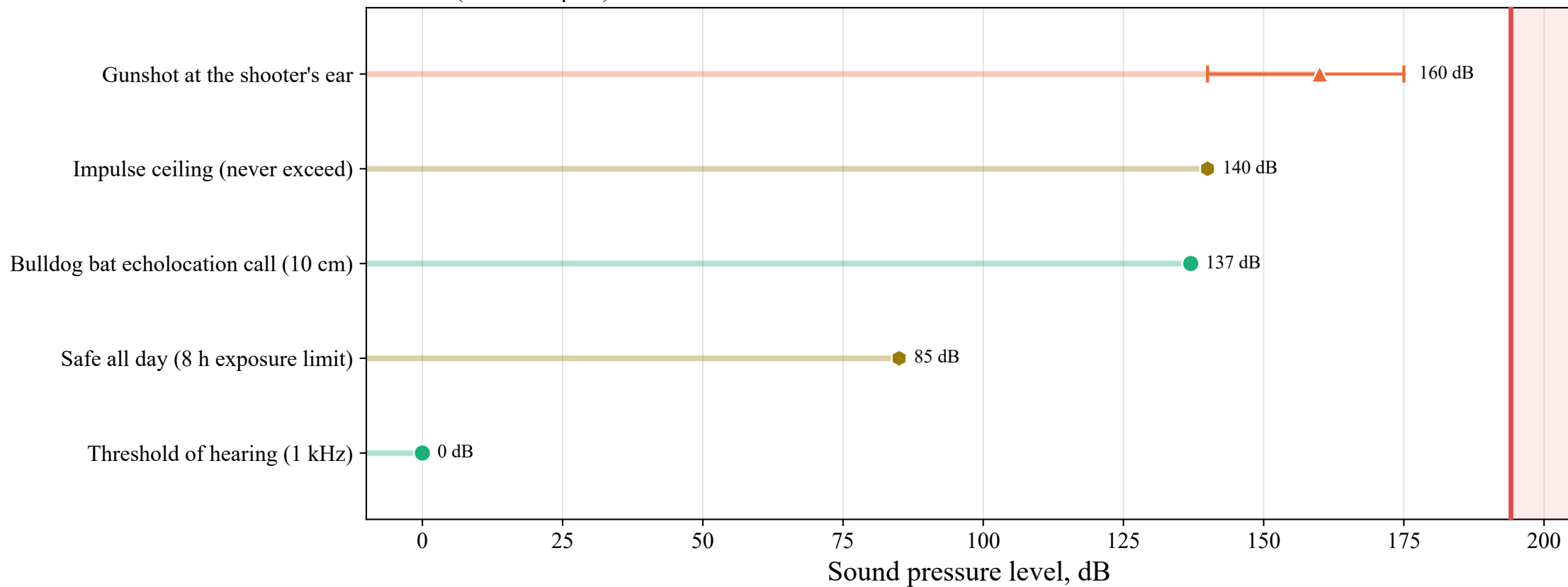
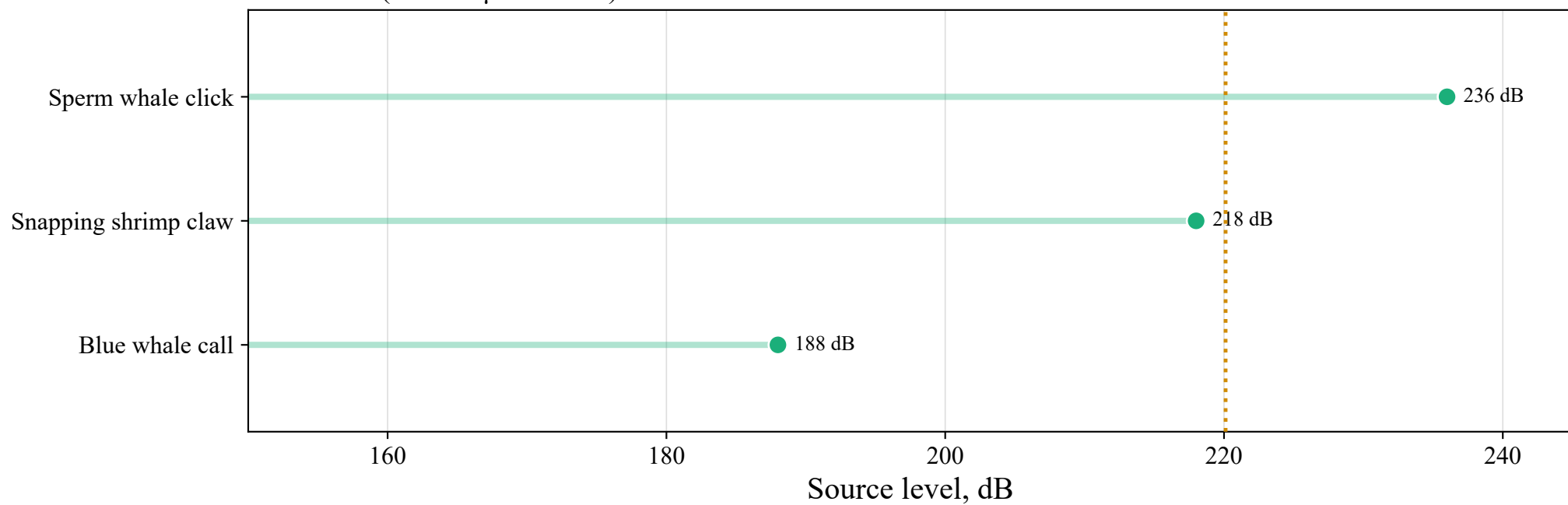


How loud can sound be?

a. In air (dB re 20 μ Pa)



b. In water (dB re 1 μ Pa at 1 m)



- Animals and hearing
- ▲ Human-made
- 194 dB in air: the trough reaches vacuum (amplitude = 1 atm)
- ◆ Exposure limits
- +— Reported range
- ⋯ 220 dB: cavitation near the surface (deeper water allows more)

Air and water levels use different reference pressures and cannot be compared directly.